Maplewood General Hospital

400 Orchard Street, New Haven, CT 06511 | Main line (203) 555-0100

Hospital Discharge Summary and Patient Instructions

Patient	Joseph Kowalski	**MRN**	MGH-0044702
Date of birth	05/09/1955	**Unit**	Medicine 4 East
Admitted	10/13/2026	**Discharged**	10/16/2026
Attending	Sofia Alvarez, MD (Pulmonology)	**Preferred language**	English

Why you were in the hospital

Diagnosis: COPD exacerbation (flare-up of chronic obstructive pulmonary disease), triggered by a viral chest infection. Current smoker, about 1 pack per day.

Hospital course (for your care team)

71M with severe COPD (GOLD 3, FEV1 42% predicted), active tobacco use (50 pack-years), admitted with AECOPD in the setting of rhinovirus infection. ABG on arrival 7.33/58/62; treated with BiPAP for 12 hours, then weaned to 2 L NC. Received methylprednisolone 40 mg IV daily x 3 days, transitioned to oral prednisone taper, and azithromycin day 2 of 5. Ambulatory SpO2 86% on room air, qualifying for home oxygen with exertion and sleep. Inhaled regimen escalated. Smoking cessation counseling provided; NRT started.

Your medications

START taking these medications

Prednisone 10 mg tablet (steroid taper). Take once daily with breakfast: 4 tablets (40 mg) on 10/17 and 10/18; then 3 tablets (30 mg) on 10/19 and 10/20; then 2 tablets (20 mg) on 10/21 and 10/22; then 1 tablet (10 mg) on 10/23 and 10/24; then stop.

Azithromycin 250 mg tablet. Take 1 tablet by mouth once daily for 3 more days (10/17, 10/18 and 10/19).

Tiotropium (Spiriva Respimat) 2.5 mcg inhaler. Take 2 inhalations once daily, at the same time each day.

Nicotine patch 14 mg/24 hours. Apply 1 new patch each morning to clean, hairless skin. Remove the old patch first. If you have vivid dreams, take the patch off at bedtime.

CHANGE how you take these medications

Fluticasone-salmeterol (Advair Diskus) 250/50 mcg. Take 1 inhalation twice daily, morning and evening. Rinse your mouth with water and spit after each use. Strength increased from 100/50.

CONTINUE taking these medications

Albuterol HFA 90 mcg inhaler. Take 2 puffs every 4 to 6 hours as needed for shortness of breath or wheezing.

Omeprazole 20 mg capsule. Take 1 capsule by mouth once daily before breakfast, to protect your stomach while on prednisone.

Home oxygen and lifestyle

Use oxygen at 2 liters per minute by nasal cannula when walking and while sleeping. The oxygen company will deliver equipment to your home on 10/16/2026.

Do not smoke, especially near oxygen; it is a fire risk. Free help to quit: 1-800-QUIT-NOW.

Follow-up appointments

Pulmonology, Dr. Sofia Alvarez: Tuesday 10/27/2026 at 2:30 PM, Maplewood Lung Center, 3rd floor. Bring all of your inhalers.

Pulmonary rehabilitation: referral sent. The rehab program will call you within 2 weeks.

Primary care: see your primary care doctor within 1 week. Call your doctor's office to schedule.

When to get help

Call the Lung Center at (203) 555-0177 if: you need your albuterol more often than every 4 hours; your mucus turns green or yellow and you have a fever; your ankles swell.

Call 911 or go to the emergency room if: you are so short of breath you cannot speak in full sentences; your lips or fingertips turn blue; you become confused or very drowsy; you have chest pain.